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CBIQ GLOBAL BENCHMARK · EVENT BRIEFING

# Global Mobility in Focus

The GME Leaders Exchange - Sydney, July 2026, set against the CBIQ global benchmark.

**30**

Global Mobility leaders who  
registered for the GME  
Leaders Exchange in Sydney

**800+**

Global Mobility leaders in  
the CBIQ benchmark

CBIQ provides the independent benchmark. The GME Leaders Exchange hosted the event. Powered by Global Mobility Executive.

## FINDING 01

# Cost is the pressure that stands out

Where the global benchmark spreads its pressures, Sydney concentrates on one.

## AMONG THE SYDNEY LEADERS

Cost management was the most cited operational pressure by a clear margin, named by around half of the leaders in the room, well ahead of immigration and regulatory change as the next most common concern.

## WHAT IT MEANS

Globally, pressure is spread fairly evenly across immigration, cost and geopolitical instability, with no single dominant concern. Sydney is different: cost stands alone at the top.

## ACROSS THE CBIQ BENCHMARK (~800 leaders, top cluster)



Base: ~800 Global Mobility leaders, top cluster.

## FINDING 02

# AI adoption is still early

The appetite to discuss AI is running ahead of adoption.

## AMONG THE SYDNEY LEADERS

Over a third of Sydney leaders were not yet using AI in their Global Mobility operations, and fewer reported active use, piloting or production, than the global benchmark shows.

## WHAT IT MEANS

The benchmark shows a room where a larger-than-global share has not yet started, and where active use trails the wider market. The interest is real; the deployment is still ahead of most programs.

## ACROSS THE CBIQ BENCHMARK (~819 leaders)



Base: ~819 Global Mobility leaders.

## FINDING 03

# A function still in transition

Most programs are adjusting, few are finished.

## AMONG THE SYDNEY LEADERS

Sydney leaders were spread fairly evenly across optimizing selected areas, reviewing processes and technology, and operating effectively, with fewer describing themselves as fully transforming.

## WHAT IT MEANS

Sydney confirms rather than diverges: the same even spread as the global benchmark, describing a function mid-adjustment rather than either settled or fully transformed.

## ACROSS THE CBIQ BENCHMARK (~778 leaders, 4 core options)



Base: ~778 Global Mobility leaders, 4 core options.

## INSIDE THE ROOM

**The benchmark shows where leaders stand.**  
**The discussions showed where they are heading.**

Drawn from the GME Advisory Board summary of the Sydney sessions.

## INSIDE THE ROOM

# Mobility is being redefined as a talent lever

Leaders described a shift in how Global Mobility is positioned: less a function that facilitates moves, more a strategic tool for attracting, developing and retaining talent. Definitions vary widely by organization, and several see an opportunity to place Global Mobility at the intersection of workforce planning, talent strategy and capability building.

## ACROSS THE CBIQ BENCHMARK (agree strongly, 6-7)

Embedded in the EVP

39%

Scope &amp; complexity will grow

49%

Bases: 656 and 642 Global Mobility leaders.

*The tension is the point: the remit is growing faster than the talent ambition is embedding.*

## INSIDE THE ROOM

# Workforce planning and mobility are converging

Alignment between workforce planning and Global Mobility is emerging as a priority, with discussion focused on organization design, skills and capability mapping, and the impact of AI and automation. International experience was recognized as a genuine capability builder, delivering diverse perspectives back into the business.

## STRATEGY ALIGNED TO ORGANIZATIONAL STRATEGY

Agree overall (5-7)



75%

Agree strongly (6-7)



44%

Base: 655 Global Mobility leaders.

*Alignment is widely felt; strong alignment is the work still in progress.*

## INSIDE THE ROOM

# Compliance is shifting from risk elimination to risk management

Cross-border working remains a major challenge, but the room described a clear move toward risk-based assessment over blanket restriction: day thresholds, definitions of productive work, traffic-light models, and compliance technology used to monitor risk and support decisions rather than block them.

## ACROSS THE CBIQ BENCHMARK (pressure cluster)



Base: ~800 Global Mobility leaders.

*Regulatory pressure is real and steady; the response is shifting from blocking to managing.*



## INSIDE THE ROOM

## Data alone is not enough

Leaders want a single source of truth built on integrations between vendors and internal systems, and they want storytelling and actionable insight on top of it. The appetite is not for more data but for clearer answers, which echoes the AI finding: interest is running ahead of deployment.

### ACROSS THE CBIQ BENCHMARK (AI adoption, ~819 leaders)



Base: ~819 Global Mobility leaders.

*Interest is running ahead of deployment.*



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## INSIDE THE ROOM

# Retention through non-traditional mobility

With headcount constrained, several organizations are using mobility creatively to retain talent: extended leave-of-absence programs, international experience pathways, alumni programs, and arrangements that keep employees connected while working externally, in one case for up to two years. The common thread is flexibility: keeping capability inside the business without a conventional assignment.



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WHERE DOES YOUR PROGRAM SIT?

# See your program against the benchmark

The figures here are drawn from the CBIQ benchmark, the independent, practitioner-contributed view of how Global Mobility programs compare. The CBIQ Mobility Maturity Scorecard lets you place your own program against it across maturity, AI adoption and operational pressure in about three minutes.

**Take the Mobility Maturity Scorecard ›**

[cbiq.ai/mobility-maturity-scorecard](https://cbiq.ai/mobility-maturity-scorecard)



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## ABOUT THE DATA

# Methodology and bases

Sydney figures reflect the 30 Global Mobility leaders who registered for the GME Leaders Exchange (Sydney, July 2026) and are directional, event-specific findings, not market-wide claims. Global figures are drawn from the CBIQ benchmark of 800+ Global Mobility leaders, with each chart's specific base stated on its slide. CBIQ provides the independent benchmark; the GME Leaders Exchange hosted the event.

*Discussion themes are drawn from the GME Advisory Board summary of the Sydney Leaders Exchange sessions and reflect the views expressed in the room, not CBIQ benchmark data.*



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